

## MARUWA (5344.T): First Take: 1Q below expectations but no surprise, details raise expectations for earnings from 2Q led by AI; reiterate Buy

MARUWA reported 1Q3/27 operating profits of ¥6.3 bn during July 29 morning trading, below our estimate of ¥7 bn. Full-year FY3/27 operating profit guidance was raised to ¥33.7 bn (from ¥29.7 bn, with the forex assumption changed to ¥158/US\$, from ¥153/US\$; GSe ¥35 bn). 1Q sales by application were c.¥9.2 bn for telecommunications (of which c.¥6 bn was for AI), c.¥3.5 bn for automotive, c.¥2.3 bn for semiconductors, and c.¥2 bn for industrial equipment. Full-year sales guidance by application was revised up to just under +50% yoy for telecommunications (**of which guidance for AI is more than double yoy, at c.¥31 bn**), just over +5% yoy for automotive, and just under +20% yoy for semiconductors. The company commented that the upward revision was prompted by the confirmation of orders and delivery dates, centered on AI applications.

The 1Q operating profit miss vs. our estimate was attributable in part to a negative impact from the partial booking in sales of shipments of less profitable inventory produced in 4Q3/26 (Jan-Mar). On the other hand, **the yield issue had already been resolved on the production front from 1Q, and inventory of low-margin AI-related products was almost entirely exhausted in 1Q.** The company's timeline for the Seto No. 2 plant to begin making a full-scale contribution to sales in 2H is also unchanged. Moreover, **the timing of the recovery in semiconductor applications was brought forward to 2Q, from the previous 2H expectation** (MARUWA commented that sales could reach ¥3 bn in 2Q). It said that **orders for semiconductor applications are at record highs.**

**While 1Q operating profits were off to a slow start relative to full-year guidance, this was in line with our prior expectations ([LINK](#)) and therefore comes as no surprise. Although the company's share price declined following the earnings announcement (-5% vs. previous day's close as of 10:30, vs. +0% for TOPIX), we view this as a good entry point ([LINK](#)). We will be looking to verify details for each business at the results briefing at 10:00 on July 31. We reiterate our Buy rating, based on our view that MARUWA is entering a phase of accelerating sales growth for AI applications driven by company-specific factors such as production capacity expansion, in addition to market expansion for AI products.**

### Price Target Risks and Methodology - MARUWA

We are Buy rated on MARUWA. Our 12-month target price is ¥89,000 (implies FY27/28 P/E of 30/23x). Our target price is based on FY28E EBITDA, and we derive the applied multiple of 12.5x from the historical correlation between the EBITDA

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margin and the EV/EBITDA multiple. Key risks include lower investment in applications that support final demand (including AI/general-purpose servers, xEV, SPE), lower demand for end products due to supply chain disruptions and inventory adjustments, and the emergence of alternative technology.

|               |                                  |                       |                      |
|---------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| <b>5344.T</b> | 12m Price Target: <b>¥89,000</b> | Price: <b>¥52,900</b> | Upside: <b>68.2%</b> |
|---------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|

| Buy                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                            | GS Forecast |              |              |               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|---------------|
| Market cap: ¥652.7bn / \$4.0bn<br>Enterprise value:<br>¥567.1bn / \$3.5bn<br>3m ADTV: ¥11.9bn / \$74.6mn<br>Japan<br>Japan Electronic<br>Components/Semiconductors<br>M&A Rank: 3<br>Leases incl. in net debt & EV?:<br>Yes | Revenue (¥ bn)             | <b>3/26</b> | <b>3/27E</b> | <b>3/28E</b> | <b>3/29E</b>  |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Op. profit (¥ bn)          | 74.5        | 92.2         | 113.8        | 132.4         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)      | 25.0        | 35.0         | 52.0         | 67.0          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | EPS (¥)                    | 27.0        | 29.7         | —            | —             |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | P/E (X)                    | 1,471.9     | 2,043.8      | 3,003.6      | 3,850.5       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | P/B (X)                    | 29.0        | 25.9         | 17.6         | 13.7          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Dividend yield (%)         | 3.6         | 3.8          | 3.2          | 2.6           |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | N debt/EBITDA (ex lease,X) | 0.2         | 0.3          | 0.4          | 0.6           |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | CROCI (%)                  | (2.2)       | (2.0)        | (1.8)        | (1.9)         |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                            | 18.3        | 24.0         | 29.7         | 32.8          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | EPS (¥)                    | <b>3/26</b> | <b>6/26E</b> | <b>9/26E</b> | <b>12/26E</b> |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                            | 479.5       | 412.2        | 491.2        | 570.2         |

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates, FactSet. Price as of 28 Jul 2026 close.

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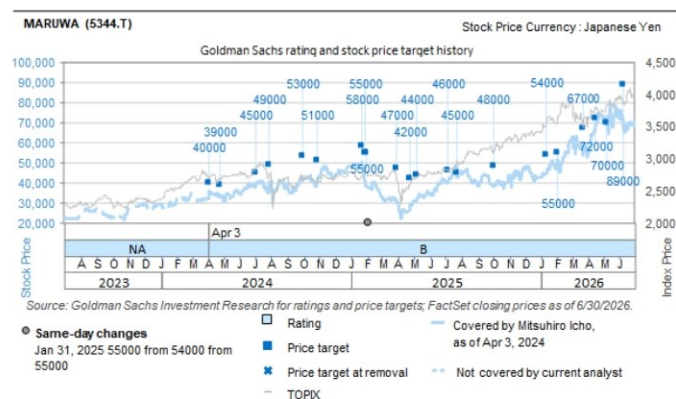
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### MARUWA (5344.T)

Date of report Target price (¥) Closing price (¥)

|           |        |        |
|-----------|--------|--------|
| 08-Jun-26 | 89,000 | 67,750 |
| 08-May-26 | 70,000 | 68,930 |
| 16-Apr-26 | 72,000 | 69,200 |
| 23-Mar-26 | 67,000 | 53,790 |
| 03-Feb-26 | 55,000 | 51,620 |
| 12-Jan-26 | 54,000 | 44,550 |
| 02-Oct-25 | 48,000 | 38,170 |
| 24-Jul-25 | 45,000 | 46,930 |
| 07-Jul-25 | 46,000 | 40,020 |
| 08-May-25 | 44,000 | 32,210 |
| 25-Apr-25 | 42,000 | 29,375 |
| 31-Mar-25 | 47,000 | 30,320 |
| 01-Feb-25 | 55,000 | 38,320 |
| 31-Jan-25 | 54,000 | 38,320 |
| 29-Jan-25 | 55,000 | 40,900 |
| 22-Jan-25 | 58,000 | 50,150 |
| 29-Oct-24 | 51,000 | 41,650 |
| 01-Oct-24 | 53,000 | 43,300 |
| 29-Jul-24 | 49,000 | 40,500 |
| 02-Jul-24 | 45,000 | 38,300 |
| 25-Apr-24 | 39,000 | 33,300 |
| 03-Apr-24 | 40,000 | 32,350 |

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